Kornerupine

△ **Fine, rectangular step-cut** greenish-brown kornerupine

Kornerupine is a rare borosilicate mineral, named in honour of the Danish geologist, Andreas Nicolaus Kornerup. Its crystals can resemble tourmaline prisms, and are found in shades of brown, green, and yellow all the way through to colourless; of all these, emerald-green and blue are the most highly valued. It is still relatively rare in faceted stones. When faceting, the lapidary must orient the stone carefully in order to obtain the best colour, with the table facet parallel to the prism faces of the crystal.

Specification

Chemical name Magnesium-aluminium borosilicate | **Formula** $Mg_3Al_6(Si,Al,B)_5O_{21}(OH)$ | **Colours** Green, white, blue | **Structure** Orthorhombic | **Hardness** 6.5–7 | **SG** 3.3–3.5 | **RI** 1.66–1.69 | **Lustre** Vitreous | **Streak** White | **Locations** Madagascar, Sri Lanka, Canada, Greenland, Norway, Russia

Kornerupine specimen | Rough | This small but excellent quality piece of kornerupine faceting rough originates from Mogok, Myanmar.

Kornerupine crystals | Rough | This specimen consists of a number of prismatic kornerupine crystals combined in a groundmass of rock.

Blue cabochon | Cut | Cut from a Tanzanian rough, this 4.38-carat blue cabochon contains a few internal flaws, but is still a desirable stone.

Kenyan kornerupine | Cut | This kornerupine from Kenya in an intense shade of green is far from flawless, but this is compensated by its bold emerald cut.

Kornerupine was first described and named in 1884, but nearly 30 years passed before the first gem-quality material was discovered

Scissors cut | Cut | This flawless kornerupine gemstone features a scissors cut crafted to emphasize both its clarity and its brilliance.

Oval brilliant | Cut | Kornerupine is such a rare gem that a few internal flaws such as the healed fractures within this 7.43-carat Sri Lankan stone are acceptable.